ECONOMICS OF AN MBA

A two-year MBA at a top B-school in India will cost anywhere between ₹20 and ₹40 lakh

In the US, the range is $150,000-250,000 for the same two-year programme

The thumb rule for students to recover the fee in most parts of the world is one year of the starting salary

The University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Arizona State University, University of Iowa in the US, and UK's Henley Business School have discontinued the two-year full-time MBA



Nothing seems difficult to access, and knowledge is perceived to be omnipresent. But there are counters to this argument.

Rishikesh T. Krishnan, Vice Chancellor, Ashoka University, thinks AI can only provide detailed analysis and recommendations. "The responsibility to decide which problem is worth solving, balancing competing interests and mobilising people to act on decision remains human," he says.

Last February, Ashoka launched the Havells School of Management & Leadership to teach students human capabilities that technology will not be able to replace at least in the near future.

"It is clear that the MBA needs to be revamped to become more interdisciplinary and experiential," he says. It must make students understand technology and AI as also economics, entrepreneurship, psychology, ethics, public policy and human



"It is clear that the MBA needs to be revamped to become more interdisciplinary and experiential"

RISHIKESH T. KRISHNAN
VICE CHANCELLOR,
ASHOKA UNIVERSITY

behaviour. "The question is not whether AI will make an MBA obsolete, but whether business schools are willing to reinvent the MBA for an AI-enabled world."

The issue is about talent availability beyond just B-schools. Harsh Chhapria, Senior Partner at McKinsey & Company, believes there is no single pathway, be it an MBA or technology background, to develop capabilities required in today's changing business environment.

"This includes understanding how businesses create value, balancing competing priorities, navigating ambiguity and leading diverse groups of people towards impact," he explains. In the case of McKinsey, the approach to talent, says Chhapria, has continued to evolve. "We have broadened the profiles and sources from which we recruit as our clients' needs have changed. At the same time, our commitment to attracting the best talent and giving them exceptional development opportunities has remained steadfast."